

Intel on top

Intel's Q3 2011 earnings have topped \$14.3 billion, which is what AMD makes in three years



The advent of the WarTab!

A massive, touchscreen tablet, measuring 2x3 feet was showcased as a potential battlefield assistant by AAI Corp

Crapware, irksome dialogs, motherboard woes, cranky GPU fans

We have solutions for all of them...

A hot laptop

The warranty period on my Dell Vostro A860 CoreDuo, 2GB Ram, 160 HDD – purchased on September 15, 2009 – has expired.

The LCD has two vertical and one horizontal line. Battery lasts only 10 minutes. The temperature of the PC goes upto 65°C and the fan makes horrible noise. Sometimes Laptop shuts down automatically.

I talked with Dell Customer Care. They asked me to extend warranty for one year for ₹15,000. Battery cost ₹6,500 extra. Total ₹21,500.

I simply plug in the adapter and work on the laptop. Will it harm my laptop if I remove the battery, plug in the adapter and work on my laptop?

What is the normal temperature of a laptop? Should I buy any local LCD screen which comes for 4-5 thousand?

Or should I simply buy another netbook for ₹21,500 rather than repair this laptop.

Ganga Mahto

You can still use your laptop by plugging it to a wall socket. In this case, your laptop's battery discharges similar to its charging rate, maintaining 100 per cent charge after a point. Li-Ion batteries lose their capacity by doing this, but since your battery doesn't boast great capacity as it is, there's no harm in using your laptop while it's connected to a wall socket.

65°C is definitely too hot for a laptop. Optimal temps hover around the 50°C mark. Heating issues can be solved by cleaning the laptop's innards from time to time. Take professional help if you've never opened your laptop's back panel to clean its fan, drive out dust using an air blower.

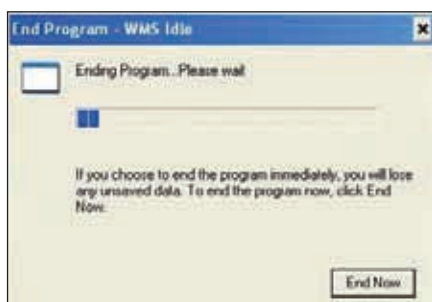
There's no point in repairing the laptop; instead, buy a new netbook. You can still utilise your laptop as a dedicated download machine or a media server.

Disabling WMS

I have a desktop PC with Windows XP SP3 32-bit system. I have a query. When I turn off my computer it shows a screen saying "WMS Idle is ending. Please Wait". How can I disable this?

Anupam Raj

WMS is a Microsoft service for media-related applications. It tends to support certain applications/services when the computer is idle. It's a common issue with those using the Nero Suite. In your case, as you use Nero Suite 7, you might want to try this: Go to **Start > All Programs > Nero > Tools > Nero Scout**.

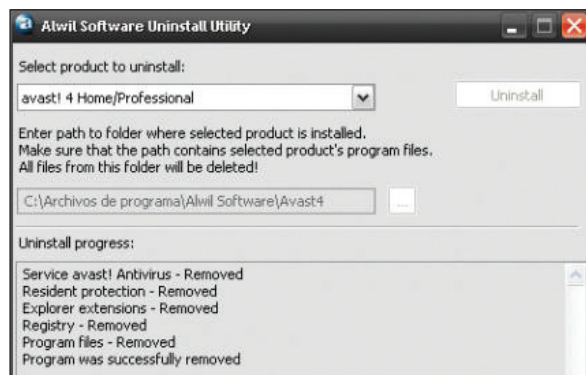


WMS Idle dialog a common issue when using Nero Suite

On this screen, Uncheck "Enable the Nero scout". This should hopefully solve the issue.

Crapware removal

I'm having issues with my PC. I recently installed Net Protector 2011. It contains a Zero-V component. The problem is that it demands that the remnants of the Avast be completely removed from the computer, which I'm unable to do. I tried deleting it from Program Files and Add or Remove Programs but to no avail.



Avast Uninstall Utility

Please help me correct this issue as it's worrying me a lot.

Also, my PC has become quite slow. Please suggest a suitable utility to correct it.

Technical specs of my PC are as follows:

- **Year of purchase:** 2006
- **CPU:** Intel Core 2 Duo
- **RAM:** Transcend 1GB.
- **Motherboard:** Intel 946GTS.
- **OS:** Windows XP SP 2
- **Hard disk:** Seagate, SATA- 160GB.

Can upgrading to a newer OS such as Windows 7 solve the speed issues.

Mainak Ghosh

Avast can be uninstalled using the uninstall utility from Avast called aswClear. You can download it from <http://bit.ly/90J9Hj> and follow the instructions mentioned there. Try installing the new anti-virus program now. Your system specs are a little dated and you have only 1 GB of RAM. Security suites tend to use a lot of processing power while scanning. First see if the uninstalling anti-virus improves the speed. You can try to upgrade your RAM in case the system is still running slow. Upgrading to Windows 7 with 1 GB of RAM doesn't make sense